

Prologue

You shall not inscribe any marks upon you; I am [the Lord] Jehovah.

– Leviticus 19:28

And he causes all, the small and the great, and the rich and the poor, and the freemen and the slaves, to be given a mark on their right hand or on their forehead, and that no one may be able to buy or sell except him who has the mark, that is, the name of the beast or the number of his name.

– Revelation 13:16-17

I've been working on a new electronic cash system that's fully peer-to-peer, with no trusted third party.

– Satoshi Nakamoto, 2008

February 2026

It was one evening when I sat down with a brother in the church to talk about the second coming of Christ and the end times, a topic almost all young Christian brothers are curious about.

“Christ is coming back, right? I mean, that’s like basically the central plot of the Bible.”

“Yeah of course.” He replied.

“But because the true Christ returns, the Antichrist must first come.”

“Yep, and then also the False Prophet (Rev. 13).”

“I feel like all Christians know that the Lord will return, but few truly know the significance of the things that must take place before the Lord comes.”

“Yeah... they must all quickly take place before the Lord comes back (Rev. 1:1) ...”

“That’s right, the Antichrist will come, and with him the mark of the beast...” I was getting a little excited, and continued. *“And he will literally force everyone alive on the earth to receive his mark (Rev. 13:16), and those without the mark cannot buy or sell, which means you cannot use money, as money facilitates buying and selling simultaneously.”*

“Yes, when the Antichrist comes, all your money will be useless, so you should store up for yourself treasures in the heavens.” He replied.

Now that was such a good scriptural reply, I thought, but it is by no means an answer to the reality that eight billion or more people will face in the foreseeable future!

"Think about it though," I said. "In this day and age, the power to turn off your ability to use money is equivalent to turning off your life! Like, nowadays you wouldn't survive for a month without using money, no food, no water, no power, no fuel, no nothing, and the Antichrist is challenging the whole world to do that for three and a half years!"

I continued. "I mean, how many people will starve to death without the ability to buy food, or in fact without the ability to buy anything? So out of necessity just to survive, people will have no choice but to get the mark of the beast! They will probably say: 'for some reason, to be able to use your money again, you only need to get a mark from the government on your right hand or forehead.'"

"Yeah, so people are definitely tricked to get the mark."

"That's right, the Bible says that people will be deceived into getting the mark of the beast (Rev. 19:20) ... I mean, by taking away everyone's ability to use money (thereby, the ability to live) and promising to give it back with "just" the requirement of getting something on their body. That is such a simple, effective, and cunning way to get people to get the mark!"

At this point, I have never come to know how well designed the mark of the beast is, or considered the seriousness of this topic, but what is next might send chills down your spine.

"If you go to the next chapter, Revelation chapter 14, it seems that all those who received the mark of the beast will likely go to the lake of fire (Rev. 14:9-11)."

"Yeah that's true, and there's nothing said in the Bible that the mark is reversible, similar to our salvation," I added. "But surely what will happen to those still alive on the earth when the Antichrist comes? Like the "sheep" the Lord said as the people that will take care of God's persecuted people during the great tribulation (Matt. 25:31-40), how will they survive, and take care of others if they can't use money?"

A very tough question, I know.

"The Lord will provide. He is sovereign over everything, so I believe there will be a way out for people from the mark of the beast. God desired all to be saved (1 Tim. 2:4), I think He wouldn't just do nothing and let everyone get the mark."

"Add Satan's will is exactly opposite to God's, so he desires all to perish in the lake of fire, hence such a clever scheme with the mark." I said.

"Yeah, that's right."

"If only we could return to the good old days of the Old Testament where everybody used gold and silver as money, and held it in their own bags, then no one can stop anyone from using money, unless by force, as people are their own bank. That way, the mark would be useless, and billions of people would actually be saved!"

“That’s clearly not the case now, that’s why you need to preach the gospel more! Don’t talk about eight billion people, if you don’t preach the gospel, you can’t even get eight people saved haha.” He said tongue-in-cheek.

“Yes, haha. I really haven’t been talking about the good news as much as I should’ve...”

There must be a solution, I thought in my heart, God will always provide a way out.

Fast forward to today, it has been around two millennia since God humbled Himself by becoming a man to walk on the earth (Phil. 2:5-7), to willingly die for the sins of the whole world (Phil 2:8; 1 Pet. 2:24), resurrected from death (Matt. 28:7), ascended to heaven (Acts 1:9-11), and made the promise to quickly return (Rev. 22:7, 12, 20). Yet, contrary to the early apostles’ and almost every generation of Christians’ beliefs that the Lord will return in their lifetime (cf. 1 Cor. 7:29; 1 Thes. 4:17), the Lord seems to ‘delay’ His return.

One of the key reasons (not the whole) lies in the schemes of the evil one, Satan (whose name means ‘the enemy’ translated from Hebrew). Who plans to destroy the whole earth and all of humanity before the time of the Lord’s return. It is like God is an owner of a beautiful house and plans to host a great party (cf. Matt. 25:10), and Satan is malicious squatter who came to occupy the house and the things within the house for himself and his underlings (1 John 5:19). So in order for God, as the rightful owner of the house to host His party which He has been looking forward to for a very long time, He must first evict the squatter and his underlings (Rev. 20:10). However, Satan threatens to blow up the whole house and all the things in the house if God tries to evict him.

God, of course, being almighty, is able to rebuild the house into something better and more beautiful (Isa. 66:22; Rev. 21:1) and evict Satan from His existing house. However, he does not choose to do so, because he also remembers that He is a master artist and craftsman (Isa. 65:8), and has countless priceless vessels, works of art, and masterpieces (2 Tim. 2:21; Eph. 2:10), all one of a kind, and all-over inside the house. And Satan is exactly taking advantage of this by taking these vessels that are priceless to God hostage. God would have evicted Satan long ago and rebuilt a new and better house, but with the threat of losing all His personal priceless possessions (cf. Mal. 3:17; 1 Pet. 2:9), He has to use a sly roundabout way to rescue them, or make them immune to the imminent destruction. Then He can evict the squatter, and even if Satan does blow up the whole house in the process, God is able to reinstall His priceless possessions in a better house that He will build from the foundation of the old one, just in time for the party to begin.

As you might have already pieced together, in this story, the priceless works of art in the house, which are God’s personal treasure, is humanity (cf. Gen. 1:26-31; Isa. 65:8), and the house is the whole world (or earth). Most importantly to the topic of this book, the ‘bomb’ which Satan uses to blow up the house, is none other than the Antichrist, who is the destroyer, Apollyon (Rev. 9:11; Dan. 8:23-24). As it is written, the Antichrist (who is also known as the beast, the destroyer) will be given power from Satan (Dan. 8:24; 2 Thes. 2:9; Rev. 13:2) and destroy the earth and humanity in an extraordinary manner (Dan. 8:24; Rev. 11:18).

The Bible reveals many diabolical plans the Antichrist intends to carry out when he arises. However, for one scheme in particular, the Bible goes into greater lengths to describe, that is the mark of the Antichrist, the mark of the beast, which appears to be an integral, central, and universal part of the Antichrist's operations (Rev. 13:16). The mark of the beast is a mark for destruction by the destroyer, as all those who receive the mark will most likely perish alongside the Antichrist when this 'bomb' blows up (Rev. 14:9-11). Therefore, to diffuse the bomb (or render it significantly less effective), a solution must be given to "diffuse" the mark of the beast.

Understanding the mark of the beast is paramount, especially how the Antichrist plans to distribute it, and the reason why people are willing to receive it. And the answer to that is found in one line of the Bible. Revelation 13:17 has been the main burden of the author and the anchor of this book; it reads: "and that no one may be able to buy or sell except him who has the mark, that is, the name of the beast or the number of his name." From this verse, we can conclude that the mechanism for the enforcement of the mark is through total economic control and coercion, and its twisted incentive is offering all to regain the ability to use money within a monetary system controlled by the Antichrist, by receiving it on the right hand or the forehead. When one's ability to use money is equivalent to one's ability to survive and live in our modern society, the incentive to get marked is especially irresistible. The mark of the beast is a "solution" offered by the very person who created the problem. It is like poisoning the world, then selling the cure, except the cure is deceptively much more deadlier.

We see that, as God is facing a dilemma with Satan, so also man will face a dilemma with the Antichrist, of either to receive his mark and face eternal perdition, or to lose the ability to use money and face deprivation and certain physical death. As I have remarked, if people are their own bank, and used a decentralised form of money that cannot be centralised, controlled, confiscated, coerced, and corrupted (which gold has functioned as, but not as perfectly), then the mark of the beast would lose its incentive and be rendered useless. From a purely selfish perspective, no one would willingly receive the mark if it provided them with no benefits. And this is where Bitcoin steps into the frame.

Contrary to the mark of the beast, Bitcoin seeks to impose itself on nobody, and as it continues to grow and accelerate in its adoption, it will be merited as a peaceful and neutral technology for the purposes of money: storing and transacting value across time and space, and not being subject to control or censorship from anyone, regardless how powerful they may be. And as a technology and tool in humanity's shed, it will survive, thrive, or die for the very same reason the paper, the wheel, the fax machine, the lightbulb, the internet, or any technology survives or is phased out: if it offers its users the most benefit from using it for the purpose(s) it was created for. And common with the introduction of any novel technology in human history, Bitcoin has its technological barriers that users must learn to overcome. Most people will not consider adopting and using Bitcoin just yet, unless with a need to.

The following is from Ralph Merkle, cryptographer and inventor of the Merkle tree data structure utilised by Bitcoin for recording transactions, on the nature of Bitcoin:

Bitcoin is the first example of a new form of life. It lives and breathes on the internet. It lives because it can pay people to keep it alive. It lives because it performs a

useful service that people will pay it to perform. It lives because anyone, anywhere, can run a copy of its code. It lives because all the running copies are constantly talking to each other. It lives because if any one copy is corrupted it is discarded, quickly and without any fuss or muss. It lives because it is radically transparent: anyone can see its code and see exactly what it does. It can't be changed. It can't be argued with. It can't be tampered with. It can't be corrupted. It can't be stopped. It can't even be interrupted. If nuclear war destroyed half of our planet, it would continue to live, uncorrupted. It would continue to offer its services. It would continue to pay people to keep it alive.

The only way to shut it down is to kill every server that hosts it. Which is hard, because a lot of servers host it, in a lot of countries, and a lot of people want to use it. Realistically, the only way to kill it is to make the service it offers so useless and obsolete that no one wants to use it. So obsolete that no one wants to pay for it. No one wants to host it. Then it will have no money to pay anyone. Then it will starve to death. But as long as there are people who want to use it, it's very hard to kill, or corrupt, or stop, or interrupt.

While Bitcoin is a novel invention, the problems it stands to solve and its value proposition of being a form of money that is incorruptible, uncensorable, unconfiscatable, and under the full control of its owner are indispensable attributes that a form of money should possess during the times of the Antichrist. Understandably, it is easy to dismiss Bitcoin, or any novel technology, as a scam or misunderstand its utility without first understanding the problem(s) it is designed to solve. As it must, the first half of the book is dedicated to thoroughly dissecting the mark of the beast, with the first chapter of the book explaining the significance of the mark of the beast to all parties involved when it appears in the end times: to God, to man, and to the devil. We will specifically analyse why the Antichrist chose to place the mark on specific locations of the human body, and how these locations' Biblical symbolism reveals the intentions the Antichrist has for his mark.

The second chapter of the book discusses the person of the Antichrist, the person behind the mark of the beast as a big piece of the puzzle in piecing together the full picture. We will see how the beast was first revealed in the Bible through the prophet Daniel's visions, and zoom in on the person of the Antichrist in the apostle John's revelations. Chapter Two goes into great detail about the identity of the Antichrist and historical records of this person's conduct and deeds to illustrate the economic significance of the mark. Moreover, how the history of the early church and the records of economic persecutions faced by early Christians under this person's reign and his successors provide a picture of the socio-economic consequences of the coming mark of the beast for the whole world in the foreseeable future.

Similar to the second chapter, the third chapter will expose the person of the False Prophet as the last member of the satanic triad (Satan, the Antichrist, and the False Prophet). We will see how he qualifies to be the enforcer of the mark of the beast and deceiver as revealed through the Lord's unsettling remarks about him, and his occupation and conduct of his past life.

The fourth chapter confronts the gravity of the problem by examining both the consequences of receiving the mark and the irresistible incentive that compels people toward it. This chapter

will unravel the blueprint and scheme of the mark before it has even come off the drawing board of the satanic triad, as the final groundwork and the starting point of our search for a solution to the problem of the mark of the beast.

As Christians and Bitcoiners alike know, holding onto what we have and what we believe in has always been a battle, and will always be. We are fighting a good fight. In any battle, intelligence is indispensable; understanding the enemy's stratagems and plans is instrumental to a victorious outcome. For this reason, the first four chapters of this book have been dedicated to exposing and understanding the problem, the architecture, and the scheme behind the mark of the beast.

Having laid bare the design, incentive, and severity of the mark of the beast, chapter five explains a very real and urgent need for a solution, and the requirements such a solution must satisfy to enable anyone in the world to endure through the great tribulation without submitting to economic coercion and the mark of the beast. By tracing the nature of money, authority, and control, this chapter exposes how the mark's single point of leverage: the ability to buy and sell, is also its single point of failure. If its incentive can be annulled, then it will be rendered useless. From there, it explores whether a medium of exchange can exist outside the control of centralised authority, and the necessary attributes it must possess to qualify as a solution to the mark.

Having arrived at Bitcoin as the sole medium capable of annulling the mark's economic coercion, a deeper question now confronts us: what is Bitcoin? To answer this, we must step back from Bitcoin itself and examine something far more fundamental: what money is. Chapter Six peels back the assumptions and prejudices we have for or against any form of money, including Bitcoin, by examining the first principles of money through creation, from Genesis to Revelation.

History often foreshadows what is to come, and it has a profound tendency to rhyme. Transitioning from theory to lived reality, Chapter Seven has been the most deeply heartfelt for the author to write and compile. This chapter is a collection of testimonies from individuals and groups among millions worldwide who have faced, and continue to face, economic repression and disenfranchisement. Drawing on events that occurred as recently as the turn of the 2020s, it reveals how all their stories unite around one notion that loudly echoes the economic reality of the mark of the beast: the weaponisation of money to serve the interests of the state.

And last but not least, after seeing the battle-testing of Bitcoin in the real world, serving as plausible scenarios that the world will witness under the reign of the Antichrist, it would be most appropriate to include a comprehensive but easy to understand guide to the utility of Bitcoin, as knowledge of the solution alone is not sufficient to constitute the solution without any application.

This book is written to help readers gain greater understandings into the pivotal event and device of the mark of the beast that must take place in the foreseeable future, and to present a methodical and critical scrutiny of the mark of the beast's incentive and design, and how it could be annulled with a medium outside of the Antichrist's control, thereby rendering the

mark of the beast useless. The author, however, is not making an advertisement or invitation to buy into the bitcoin currency, neither is this book on theology or religion, and nor was it written in the realm of speculation. For from it.

The content of this book is provided for informational purposes only; it is neither authoritative nor complete. The author acknowledges the uncertainty of the future, and remains cautious that the Bitcoin network may yet succeed or fail, and the mark of the beast may or may not occur in our lifetimes. All things are under God's sovereignty (Job 42:2; Eph. 1:11). The author holds onto the truth that the Bible is absolute truth, and the true word of God (John 17:17; 2 Tim. 3:16). Therefore, it is written with the optimism and hope that as cunning and effective the mark of the beast is, God will provide (or has provided) a solution to it, so that the people still alive on earth during the reign of the Antichrist would not succumb to the mark of the beast to suffering the same fate as the beast himself.

So far, Bitcoin, as a decentralised, global, digital, peer-to-peer, and control-resistant protocol, is the best candidate to address the mark of the beast in a foreseeable world of economic coercion. Should a medium of exchange emerge superior to Bitcoin in all the attributes and monetary properties discussed in the book (Chapters Five and Six), it would most likely be of the same principles, attributes, and properties that pertain to decentralised moneys like gold and Bitcoin, and be even more effective against the mark of the beast. For now, this book aims to illustrate how Bitcoin's attributes and monetary properties enable it to address the economic dilemma of the mark which no other forms of money can.

Equipped with such understanding from this book, and after thorough research and considerations into the practical aspects of owning, storing, and using bitcoins, should anyone consider holding value. Consider the simple analogy of riding a bike; the most important investment one makes is not the \$100 spent on purchasing the bike, but the 100 hours dedicated to learning to ride it safely.

This book might be read by people a century before the arrival of the Antichrist, or a decade before, or on the day when he arises, or even during the great tribulation. Should you emerge from this book believing Bitcoin is worth holding and using, or realise a need for it given your circumstances, your first investment should be time spent learning how to buy, store, secure and use it correctly. Bitcoin teaches that responsibility cannot be delegated or outsourced. When you outsource responsibility for anything, you effectively forfeit your ownership of it, whether it be knowledge, your bitcoins, or your savings held by a financial institution.

Without further ado, let's begin.